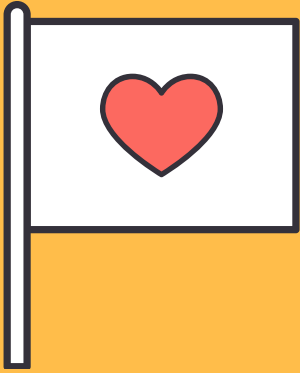


5 STEPS TO HELPING YOUR CHILD SOLVE CONFLICTS



1. IDENTIFY FEELINGS

Reflect on how your child appears to be feeling without judgement.

- "Your hands are making a fist. You seem angry."
- "You seem sad."
- "You feel like yelling/throwing something. You seem frustrated."

Or, simply ask: "How do you feel about that?"



2. ALLOW TIME TO PROCESS FEELINGS

A child who is very angry or sad may need some time to process what has happened and what they are feeling. Provide them a safe, quiet space to be alone and express themselves as necessary. Some children like to draw, use play doh, or other sensory items to calm themselves.



3. LET THEM FIND A SOLUTION

Many times, children can come up with their own solutions. Ask "What do you think you should do?" and listen, again without judgement.

If they are having trouble, they might need more time to calm down or they might need you to set some boundaries or choices for them. For example, you may not hit your sister, but you may punch your bean bag or your pillow if you feel like hitting something.

4. ENCOURAGE COMMUNICATION



Teach them to use their I-Statements whenever possible to communicate their feelings and wishes.

"I feel ____ when you ____."

Or

"I don't like it when you _____. Please don't _____ anymore."



5. REFLECT INWARD

Sometimes, children can be very sensitive to changes. Is something different at home? Maybe you are moving, changing jobs, or having another baby? Or maybe there's just been some tension at home. Perhaps your child is simply not feeling well. Reflect and notice if something else might be bothering them.

SOURCE:

<http://robinkoogle.wordpress.com/>